

NatWest Group Interview Experience (Internship)

About NatWest Group

National Westminster Bank commonly known as **NatWest** is a leading British banking and financial services company headquartered in Edinburgh, Scotland. Formed in 1968 through the merger of National Provincial Bank and Westminster Bank, it operates major subsidiaries including NatWest, RBS, Ulster Bank, Coutts, and NatWest Markets. As one of the UK's "Big Four" banks, it serves millions of retail, commercial, and private customers, offering strong digital solutions while focusing on innovation, customer experience, and sustainability with a net zero commitment by 2050.

Eligibility Criteria

- **CGPA:** 6.0 and above from 10th onwards
- **No Current Arrear**

Selection Process

1. Online Assessment (Offline @CUIC)
2. Pre-Placement Talk (Offline @CUIC)
3. Technical + HR Interview (Offline @CUIC)

Online Assessment

Online assessment was conducted on **25th August 2025** on the **SHL Platform at CUIC**. It consisted of **four sections** which could be attempted in any order.

1. Coding (45 minutes, 2 questions, free navigation)

- The questions were **array-based** and of **easy difficulty level**.
- A driver code was provided; we only had to implement the required function.
- Each participant was randomly assigned a different set of questions.

Question 1:

Given an **array of integers** and two values, **start** and **end**, return a new array containing only the elements that lie between start and end (**inclusive**), while preserving their original order.

Input: Array: [12, 76, 34, 98, 11, 54, 63, 45]

Start: 30

End: 60

Output:

Array: [34, 54, 45]

Question 2:

Given an *n-digit number* return the smallest possible *n-digit* number that can be formed using its digits.

Input:

Number: 90018

Output:

Number: 10089

Although the questions were presented with additional filler context, the core expectation was exactly as written here.

2. SQL (15 minutes, 10-12 questions, free navigation)

- The questions involving selecting the correct option that produced the given output, determining the output of queries, and answering a few conceptual questions.
- This section was relatively easy and could be solved with basic SQL knowledge.
- It is recommended to be acquainted with SQL fundamentals and practice solving SQL queries beforehand.

3. General Aptitude (36 minutes, 24 questions, no free navigation)

- An optional practice test was available before the actual test. It is recommended to attend it, as the questions were quite different from those in other OAs. Attending this test also helps in becoming familiar with the platform.
- The section was interactive, and the questions required scheduling meetings, adjusting bar graphs/pie charts to reflect correct percentage values (calculated from the given information), completing graphs based on node values, selecting dates, and assigning rooms based on given criteria.
- Overall, the questions were of medium difficulty but time-consuming.

4. English Aptitude (15 minutes, 12 questions, no free navigation)

- This section comprised reading comprehension, synonyms and antonyms, error spotting, identifying the correct sequence of sentences.

23 Students were shortlisted after this round. The shortlist was announced a day before the interview.

Technical Interview + HR Interview (25 to 30 minutes)

A **PPT session** was held on **29th August 2025 at CUIC**. Generally, there was only one round of interview with two panel members. The interview for interns started at around **2.00 pm**. The entire interview was based on my **Resume** and the answers I provided.

Introduction

I was asked to introduce myself. It is important to keep the introduction **short and crisp**, and be clear in advance about what you will share, as the panel may ask follow-up questions based on your introduction.

Projects

I was asked to explain all the projects I had listed in my resume. I described:

- What the project was about,
- Why I chose to do it,
- The tech stack I used and the reasons for choosing it, and
- The impact of the project.

SQL query

I was asked an SQL query related to one of my projects, It was an easy question involving **JOINS** and multiple **WHERE clauses**, they began with a basic query and then added a few follow-ups, and finally I was asked to explain my approach. I also provided an alternative solution.

It is important to clearly explain your thought process and approach to the interviewers.

Technical Section:

- What is the difference between **map** and **hashmap**?
- I was asked about my **preferred programming language**, the reason for choosing it and was also asked why I had learned four languages.

- How strong am I in **DSA**?
- What are the **applications of linked list**?
- Since I had mentioned **SDLC** in my resume under coursework, they asked me to explain what I knew about SDLC.
- I was then asked to explain about **Normalization in DBMS**.
- They asked why I had used **Google Colab** (as mentioned in my resume). I explained that I had used it as part of my **Gen AI coursework**.

HR Section:

I was given a chance to ask questions—**don't miss this opportunity!**

I asked the panel about their **journey at NatWest**, and they were quite invested in sharing their experiences. I then asked about the **involvement of AI at NatWest**, their **expectations from a fresher**, and the **kind of work I would be doing there**. Finally, I asked for their **suggestions on my resume**.

Finally, **9 students** were shortlisted for the internship, and I am glad to be one among them.

Resources

For DSA:

- <https://takeuforward.org/strivers-a2z-dsa-course/strivers-a2z-dsa-course-sheet-2/>
- <https://takeuforward.org/interviews/strivers-sde-sheet-top-coding-interview-problems>
- <https://neetcode.io/practice?tab=neetcode150>
- <https://leetcode.com/studyplan/leetcode-75/>
- C.O.D.E series by ACM CEG.

For SQL:

- <https://sqlbolt.com/>
- <https://leetcode.com/studyplan/top-sql-50/>
- <https://www.geeksforgeeks.org/sql/sql-tutorial/>

For Technical subjects:

- <https://takeuforward.org/interviews/must-do-questions-for-dbms-cn-os-interviews-sde-core-sheet/>

For Aptitude:

- <https://www.indiabix.com/aptitude/questions-and-answers/>

My Personal Experience

I started my preparation during the **summer vacation of my second year**. I used to solve 2–3 DSA problems each day on **LeetCode** and **GeeksforGeeks** (though I had solved problems on LeetCode earlier, I wasn't consistent back then).

I didn't really feel the **heat of the competition** until I started receiving notifications about internships and updates on selected candidates in WhatsApp groups. That's when I **sped up my preparation**.

For the **OA**, I brushed up on **SQL concepts**, revised **general aptitude** from **IndiaBix**, and practiced a few problems on **LeetCode**. I also went through **placement experiences** and solved problems similar to those.

Note: Don't forget to bring your calculator.

For the **interview**, I would advise studying **OS, DBMS, OOPS, and CN concepts** in advance. Don't postpone this until the last moment (which is what I did). Even though I wasn't asked about OS, CN, and OOPS, many companies do ask them, so it's better to be prepared.

Note: Be thorough with your resume, I was asked about SDLC because I had listed it. Make sure you can explain your projects clearly: why you chose this project, its outcome, highlighted features, the tech stack you used, why you used it, and be ready for follow-up questions.

General Advice

- Maintain proper posture during the interview.
- **Communication is the key.**
- Start your preparation **as early as possible**, but remember it's never too late to start.
- Intern drives can be overwhelming but keep improving your skills and the results will follow.

All our dreams can come true, if we have the courage to pursue them. ~ Walt Disney.

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All the very best! Feel free to reach out to me!